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Ref. no: CRTC/CEE/G20220443/S- 79

SUB-SOIL INVESTIGATION REPORT

FOR THE PROPOSED SIX STORIED BANGLADESH PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION (BPSC) REGIONAL OFFICE BUILDING AT KUCHAI, SYLHET.

CLIENT

EXECUTIVE ENGINEER, PWD, SYLHET.

Verification Code: 0Yc95J9G
Verify report at: crtc-cee-sust.com

CONDUCTED BY

CENTER FOR RESEARCH TESTING & CONSULTANCY
DEPARTMENT OF CIVIL & ENVIRONMENTAL ENGINEERING
SHAHJALAL UNIVERSITY OF SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY, SYLHET

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Introduction

A reasonably accurate conception about the sub-soil parameters of any project site is an essential prerequisite for proper planning and designing the foundation of the structure so that the same after its construction would remain safe and serviceable. A detailed study on the sub-surface elements in this regard would necessary to select proper type of foundation.

Objectives

The purpose of sub-soil investigation program is to obtain the following information

1. To classify the formation of soil layers
2. To estimate the safe bearing capacities of the foundation at different soil layers
3. To suggest the safe and appropriate type of foundations.

Scope of work

Centre for research, testing and consultancy (CRTC), Department of Civil and Environmental Engineering, Shahjalal University of Science & Technology (SUST), Sylhet; execute only the laboratory tests and other computational works with the supplied disturbed and/or undisturbed samples to determine the geotechnical properties of the soil.

Table – 1: Items of the supplied samples

No	Name	Bore hole no	Depth	Quantities
01	Disturbed sample	01	0-80 ft	16
02	Disturbed sample	02	0-80 ft	16
03	Disturbed sample	03	0-75 ft	15
04	Disturbed sample	04	0-80 ft	16
05	Disturbed sample	05	0-80 ft	16
06	Disturbed sample	06	0-75 ft	15
07	Disturbed sample	07	0-70 ft	14
08	-	-	-	-
09	-	-	-	-
10	-	-	-	-

Laboratory Classifications

The disturbed soil samples, supplied by the client were thoroughly examined and classified roughly (color and type) and noted in accordance with bore hole (BH) and depth (Please see enclosed Tables).

Laboratory Works & Analysis

In addition to visual examination of the sample, Bearing Capacity of soil samples including skin friction & end bearing were calculated.

Bearing capacity for shallow foundation

The N value gives useful information with regards to consistency of cohesive soil and relative density of cohesion less soil. These relationships are given in the following Tables for cohesive and cohesion less soil, respectively.

Table 2: Relation of N-value with the Consistency and the Unconfined Compressive Strength of Cohesive Soils (after Bowles 1997)

N-values	Consistency	Unconfined Compressive Strength (q_u)	
		tsf	kPa
0-2	Very soft	0 to 0.25	0 to 25
3-5	Soft	0.25 to 0.50	25 to 50
6-9	Medium	0.50 to 1	50 to 100
10-16	Stiff	1 to 2	100 to 200
17-30	Very stiff	2 to 4	200 to 400
>30	Hard	>4	>400

Table 3: N and ϕ Relation to Relative Density for Fine Sand (after Bowles 1997)

N values	Compactness	Relative Density, Dr %	ϕ (degree)	Unit Weight (pcf)
1 – 2	Very Loose	0 – 15	26 – 28	70 – 100
3 – 6	Loose	15 – 35	28 – 30	90 – 115
7 – 15	Medium	35 – 65	30 – 34	110 – 130
16 – 30	Dense	65 – 85	33 – 38	110 – 140
>30	Very Dense	>85	>50	130 – 150

Table 4: N and ϕ Relation to Relative Density for Medium Sand (after Bowles 1997)

N values	Compactness	Relative Density, Dr %	ϕ (degree)	Unit Weight (pcf)
2 – 3	Very Loose	0 – 15	27 – 28	70 – 100
4 – 7	Loose	15 – 35	30 – 32	90 – 115
8 – 20	Medium	35 – 65	32 – 36	110 – 130
21 – 40	Dense	65 – 85	36 – 42	110 – 140

Table 5: N and ϕ Relation to Relative Density for Coarse Sand (after Bowles 1997)

N values	Compactness	Relative Density, Dr %	ϕ (degree)	Unit Weight (pcf)
3 – 6	Very Loose	0 – 15	28 – 30	70 – 100
5 – 9	Loose	15 – 35	30 – 34	90 – 115
10 – 25	Medium	35 – 65	33 – 40	110 – 130
26 – 40	Dense	65 – 85	40 – 50	110 – 140
>40	Very Dense	>85	>50	130 – 150

<u>Bearing capacity for deep foundation</u>

Foundations, preferably piles are considered to transmit heavy load from superstructure to deep and hard strata. As the formation of soil strata consists of cohesive and non-cohesive type, the evaluation criteria for the determination of skin friction and the end bearing capacities of piles also vary. Details of the evaluation are provided in the following sub-headings.

Table 6: Formula Used to Determine Bearing Capacity of Soil

Shallow Foundation	
For Cohesive Soil	
$q_a = q_u + \gamma \frac{D}{3}$ $q_a = q_u$(Common Practice)	Where, q_a=Allowable bearing capacity, q_u= Unconfined Compressive Strength, γ= Unit Weight of soil, D= Depth of footing
For Cohesion less Soil	
$q_{ult} = 30N$; $q_a = q_{ult}/FS$	q_{ult}= Ultimate bearing capacity in kPa, N = SPT Number, FS= Factor of Safety
Source: Bowles, J. E., "Physical and Geotechnical Properties of Soils", 2nd Edition	
Deep Foundation	
For Cohesive Soil	
$f_{su} = \alpha C_u$; $q_{pu} = N_c C_u$	α = Adhesion factor, f_{su} = Ultimate skin friction, C_u = Undrained Shear Strength, q_{pu} = Ultimate end bearing of pile, N_c = Bearing capacity factor for deep foundation=9
For Cohesion less Soil	
$f_{su} = N/50\ tsf$; $q_{pu} = 4N\ tsf$	f_{su} = Ultimate skin friction, q_{pu} = Ultimate end bearing of pile, N = SPT Number
Source: Rajapakse RA (2008), "Geotechnical Engineering Calculations and Rules of Thumb"	

Based on the above formula, the important parameters for foundation design have been determined and are given in **Table 7**, **Table 8, Table 9, Table 10 and Table 11** respectively.

Table 7: The allowable bearing capacity for shallow foundation in Tsf (FS=2.5)

Bore Hole No.	**Depth**	**Design N**	**Clay**						**Sand**
			Continuous			**Square(Isolated)**			
	(ft)	**-**	**D/B=0.25**	**D/B=0.5**	**D/B=1**	**D/B=0.25**	**D/B=0.5**	**D/B=1**	
BH01	**2.5-5.0**	**3**	0.394	0.415	0.452	0.466	0.503	0.547	0.425
	5.0-10	**4**	0.424	0.446	0.486	0.501	0.541	0.588	0.457
BH02	**2.5-5.0**	**3**	0.371	0.390	0.426	0.438	0.474	0.515	0.400
	5.0-10	**3**	0.344	0.362	0.394	0.406	0.439	0.477	0.371
BH03	**2.5-5.0**	**3**	0.325	0.342	0.372	0.384	0.414	0.451	0.350
	5.0-10	**3**	0.352	0.370	0.404	0.416	0.449	0.489	0.379
BH04	**2.5-5.0**	**3**	0.325	0.342	0.372	0.384	0.414	0.451	0.350
	5.0-10	**3**	0.308	0.324	0.353	0.364	0.393	0.427	0.332
BH05	**2.5-5.0**	**3**	0.394	0.415	0.452	0.466	0.503	0.547	0.425
	5.0-10	**4**	0.504	0.530	0.578	0.595	0.643	0.700	0.543
BH06	**2.5-5.0**	**4**	0.510	0.537	0.585	0.603	0.651	0.708	0.550
	5.0-10	**3**	0.388	0.408	0.445	0.458	0.495	0.539	0.418
BH07	**2.5-5.0**	**3**	0.348	0.366	0.399	0.411	0.444	0.483	0.375
	5.0-10	**3**	0.384	0.404	0.440	0.454	0.490	0.533	0.414
BH08	**2.5-5.0**	**0**	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
	5.0-10	**0**	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
BH09	**2.5-5.0**	**0**	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
	5.0-10	**0**	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
BH10	**2.5-5.0**	**0**	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
	5.0-10	**0**	-	-	-	-	-	-	-

Table 8: The allowable skin friction for Precast driven piles in Tsf (FS=2.5)

Depth	Bore Hole									
ft	BH01	BH02	BH03	BH04	BH05	BH06	BH07	BH08	BH09	BH10
5	0.074	0.096	0.096	0.096	0.074	0.174	0.074	-	-	-
10	0.096	0.096	0.049	0.074	0.096	0.074	0.096	-	-	-
15	0.074	0.049	0.074	0.049	0.074	0.096	0.049	-	-	-
20	0.096	0.074	0.096	0.074	0.138	0.074	0.096	-	-	-
25	0.096	0.096	0.156	0.074	0.118	0.096	0.096	-	-	-
30	0.156	0.118	0.096	0.096	0.096	0.096	0.118	-	-	-
35	0.118	0.138	0.074	0.074	0.074	0.074	0.118	-	-	-
40	0.096	0.096	0.096	0.074	0.074	0.096	0.112	-	-	-
45	0.088	0.096	0.144	0.168	0.096	0.072	0.118	-	-	-
50	0.074	0.118	0.118	0.096	0.074	0.096	0.096	-	-	-
55	0.096	0.096	0.138	0.096	0.118	0.138	0.118	-	-	-
60	0.118	0.118	0.156	0.118	0.118	0.118	0.184	-	-	-
65	0.096	0.156	0.184	0.138	0.160	0.184	0.184	-	-	-
70	0.176	0.176	0.176	0.176	0.176	0.176	0.176	-	-	-
75	0.168	0.168	0.168	0.168	0.168	0.168	-	-	-	-
80	0.168	0.168	-	0.168	0.168	-	-	-	-	-
85	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
90	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
95	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
100	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-

Table 9: The allowable end bearing for Precast driven piles in Tsf (FS=2.5)

Depth	Bore Hole									
ft	BH01	BH02	BH03	BH04	BH05	BH06	BH07	BH08	BH09	BH10
5	0.675	0.900	0.900	0.900	0.675	1.800	0.675	-	-	-
10	0.900	0.900	0.450	0.675	0.900	0.675	0.900	-	-	-
15	0.675	0.450	0.675	0.450	0.675	0.900	0.450	-	-	-
20	0.900	0.675	0.900	0.675	1.350	0.675	0.900	-	-	-
25	0.900	0.900	1.575	0.675	1.125	0.900	0.900	-	-	-
30	1.575	1.125	0.900	0.900	0.900	0.900	1.125	-	-	-
35	1.125	1.350	0.675	0.675	0.675	0.675	1.125	-	-	-
40	0.900	0.900	0.900	0.675	0.675	0.900	22.400	-	-	-
45	17.600	19.200	28.800	33.600	19.200	14.400	1.125	-	-	-
50	0.675	1.125	1.125	0.900	0.675	0.900	0.900	-	-	-
55	0.900	0.900	1.350	0.900	1.125	1.350	1.125	-	-	-
60	1.125	1.125	1.575	1.125	1.125	1.125	36.800	-	-	-
65	0.900	1.575	36.800	1.350	32.000	36.800	36.800	-	-	-
70	35.200	35.200	35.200	35.200	35.200	35.200	35.200	-	-	-
75	33.600	33.600	33.600	33.600	33.600	33.600	-	-	-	-
80	33.600	33.600	-	33.600	33.600	-	-	-	-	-
85	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
90	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
95	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
100	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-

Table 10: The allowable skin friction for Bored piles in Tsf (FS=2.5)

Depth	Bore Hole									
ft	BH01	BH02	BH03	BH04	BH05	BH06	BH07	BH08	BH09	BH10
5	0.048	0.062	0.062	0.062	0.048	0.113	0.048	-	-	-
10	0.062	0.062	0.032	0.048	0.062	0.048	0.062	-	-	-
15	0.048	0.032	0.048	0.032	0.048	0.062	0.032	-	-	-
20	0.062	0.048	0.062	0.048	0.090	0.048	0.062	-	-	-
25	0.062	0.062	0.101	0.048	0.077	0.062	0.062	-	-	-
30	0.101	0.077	0.062	0.062	0.062	0.062	0.077	-	-	-
35	0.077	0.090	0.048	0.048	0.048	0.048	0.077	-	-	-
40	0.062	0.062	0.062	0.048	0.048	0.062	0.073	-	-	-
45	0.057	0.062	0.094	0.109	0.062	0.047	0.077	-	-	-
50	0.048	0.077	0.077	0.062	0.048	0.062	0.062	-	-	-
55	0.062	0.062	0.090	0.062	0.077	0.090	0.077	-	-	-
60	0.077	0.077	0.101	0.077	0.077	0.077	0.120	-	-	-
65	0.062	0.101	0.120	0.090	0.104	0.120	0.120	-	-	-
70	0.114	0.114	0.114	0.114	0.114	0.114	0.114	-	-	-
75	0.109	0.109	0.109	0.109	0.109	0.109	-	-	-	-
80	0.109	0.109	-	0.109	0.109	-	-	-	-	-
85	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
90	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
95	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
100	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-

Table 11: The allowable end bearing for Bored piles in Tsf (FS=3.0)

Depth	Bore Hole									
ft	BH01	BH02	BH03	BH04	BH05	BH06	BH07	BH08	BH09	BH10
5	0.304	0.405	0.405	0.405	0.304	0.810	0.304	-	-	-
10	0.405	0.405	0.203	0.304	0.405	0.304	0.405	-	-	-
15	0.304	0.203	0.304	0.203	0.304	0.405	0.203	-	-	-
20	0.405	0.304	0.405	0.304	0.608	0.304	0.405	-	-	-
25	0.405	0.405	0.709	0.304	0.506	0.405	0.405	-	-	-
30	0.709	0.506	0.405	0.405	0.405	0.405	0.506	-	-	-
35	0.506	0.608	0.304	0.304	0.304	0.304	0.506	-	-	-
40	0.405	0.405	0.405	0.304	0.304	0.405	10.080	-	-	-
45	7.920	8.640	12.960	15.120	8.640	6.480	0.506	-	-	-
50	0.304	0.506	0.506	0.405	0.304	0.405	0.405	-	-	-
55	0.405	0.405	0.608	0.405	0.506	0.608	0.506	-	-	-
60	0.506	0.506	0.709	0.506	0.506	0.506	16.560	-	-	-
65	0.405	0.709	16.560	0.608	14.400	16.560	16.560	-	-	-
70	15.840	15.840	15.840	15.840	15.840	15.840	15.840	-	-	-
75	15.120	15.120	15.120	15.120	15.120	15.120	-	-	-	-
80	15.120	15.120	-	15.120	15.120	-	-	-	-	-
85	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
90	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
95	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
100	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-

CONCLUSION AND RECOMMENDATION

On the basis of analysis and information provided by the owner following recommendations are suggested for the proposed six storied regional office building.

Soil profile scenario

Overall soil information of the investigated site is quite regular in between the boreholes and also vertical consistency exists in the soil formation. For all the boreholes, 35-40 ft of soil contains grey soft clay with very low bearing capacity from EGL followed by a fine sand layer at 40-45 ft depth. After that, again from 40-45 ft depth, grey soft clay with very low bearing capacity have been observed up to 55-65 ft depth followed by a reddish fine sand layer as client provided. From the above discussion it is very clear that the whole scenario of the proposed site is quite invariable in nature.

Foundation options

In this situation, the foundation should be selected considering both the dimension and design load for the proposed building. Since soft clay soil with low bearing capacity is found in different layer of soil formation up to 35-40 ft depth, it will be troublesome to install any shallow foundation for this building. Because the black organic soil is very sensitive to the settlement, it is highly recommended to avoid it in case of the foundation depth selection. In this respect, deep foundation (Bored pile) may be selected to ensure the stability of the structure and to overcome the ground improvement complication. For designing any suitable deep foundation, the necessary data for skin friction and end bearing can be found from the attached table (10 and 11) in the report which is based on existing soil conditions.

Safety provisions

It is strongly recommended to check the **settlement** of the site considering building load while designing either shallow or deep foundation. Obviously **pile load test** covering the entire project area must be carried out for confirming the design parameters of the service pile (*if pile foundation is considered*). Moreover, the earthquake vulnerability of the project area as well as the quality management of the construction work including workmanship should be taken into account for the safe design of shallow or deep foundation.

Attachments

The layout of the bore holes of the investigated site and the bore-log profiles with SPT values is shown in the Appendix. Client performed no special laboratory test for the proposed site.

Special notes

These suggestions are absolutely tentative and selection of type, depth and dimensions of foundation would be decided by the Consultant or Design Engineer. It is to be noted that the recommendation is restricted to the existing soil condition of **70-80** ft as client provided.

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